

Grace



A man in a worn coat sits wide-eyed at a table he did not set: bread, meat, fruit, wine. He brought his hunger. God brought the meal.

Before you gather

- Read Day 4, Grace, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read 2 Samuel 9:6–8, 13 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

Name one good thing in your life you could not have paid for.

Leader. Stay on inability, not on a favorite gift. Then open 2 Samuel 9. Grace lives where we cannot pay. Do not reteach the journal. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: This man did not set the table. Grace is God feeding sinners who came in empty, at the cost of His Son.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Grace is God's unmerited favor freely given to sinners who deserve judgment, granting them salvation, forgiveness, and every spiritual blessing through Jesus Christ. It is not earned, deserved, or repaid; it flows from God's sovereign goodness and love.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek charis — grace, favor, a gift freely given.

MEMORY VERSE · EPHESIANS 2:8–9

For by grace you have been saved through faith. And this is not your own doing; it is the gift of God, not a result of works, so that no one may boast.

Together, open the flashcard for Grace. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

2 Samuel 9:6–8, 13

Mephibosheth is a lame man from a fallen house. David seats him for Jonathan's sake. Stay in this story. Ask what the text says before anyone talks about how grace makes them feel. But God gave us these words.

And Mephibosheth the son of Jonathan, son of Saul, came to David and fell on his face and paid homage. And David said, "Mephibosheth!" And he answered, "Behold, I am your servant." And David said to him, "Do not fear, for I will show you kindness for the sake of your father Jonathan, and I will restore to you all the land of Saul your father, and you shall eat at my table always." And he paid homage and said, "What is your servant, that you should show regard for a dead dog such as I?" ... So Mephibosheth lived in Jerusalem, for he ate always at the king's table.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. What had Mephibosheth done to earn a seat, and what exactly did David give him?

CORE

Leader. Nothing earned it. David showed kindness for Jonathan's sake, restored the land, lifted the fear, and gave him a permanent place at the king's table. The reason is another man's covenant, not this man's record.

2. He calls himself a dead dog. Does David argue him into a better opinion of himself, or does he set a place?

Leader. David sets the place. Grace does not wait until we feel worthy. It seats the person who knows he does not belong. The gospel does not start with self-esteem. It starts with the King's kindness.

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. Ephesians 2:8-9 says we are saved by grace through faith, and this is not our own doing, so that no one may boast. What do we still try to add as our part?

Leader. Sincerity, a decision, a sad enough repentance, church loyalty, or not being as bad as someone else. Paul says salvation, including the faith that receives it, is the gift of God. Not of works. No one may boast.

4. Romans 6:1 asks if we should sin so that grace may abound. Where does 'grace means my sin does not matter' get the gift wrong? CORE

Leader. Paul says, 'By no means.' We died to sin. Titus 2:11-12 says grace trains us to renounce ungodliness. Grace is not a permit. It is a gift that trains the sinner. Jesus came to die, not to excuse us.

5. 2 Corinthians 8:9 says Christ became poor so that we might become rich. How does that cost keep gratitude from turning into entitlement?

Leader. Entitlement says, 'Of course.' Worship says, 'It cost Him.' He was our substitute. The table is free to us and costly to the Son. Ask what entitlement sounds like in prayer, then go back to the verse.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Grace is God's free gift of salvation to sinners, received by faith in Jesus alone.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Give a real gift to someone far from Jesus who cannot pay you back. Tell them it is not a trade. Grace is God giving sinners what they do not deserve, through faith in Jesus.

Leader. Do not post it. The gift is for them, and the sentence has to name Jesus. A kindness that never names Christ is not the whole challenge. We are sent because He is worthy, not so we can feel generous. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 · PRAY · 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Father, thank You for a seat at Your table that we did not earn.
2. Forgive the boast we keep trying to add. Salvation is Your gift, through faith.
3. Let grace train us this week, and send us with a gift and a true word about Jesus.

Before you stumble

Part I ends here. Do not start the sin week tonight unless you have time for a clean handoff. A good last line: 'Next time we tell the truth about why this table was necessary.' If someone says they earned a little of it, do not leave that false gospel sitting. Read Ephesians 2:8-9 again. Some will not feel like sinners yet. Do not force a story. The text does the work.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what a team banquet feels like if you did not make the team and someone seats you anyway. Then ask who paid. Keep Jesus as the cost. Christ became poor. The coach is not the Savior.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Titus 2:11-14. The grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation, and it trains us to live godly lives while we wait for our blessed hope. Use it if Romans 6 needs a second witness.